THE DISPATCH DESK
AI TOOLKIT

12 ready-to-use AI prompts that save truck dispatchers hours every week

Planning loads | Driver communication | Broker & customer emails | Running the desk

Built by a former dispatcher, freight broker & sales manager

How to Use This Toolkit

Dispatch is mostly communication: texts to drivers, emails to brokers, updates to customers, and planning that lives in your head. AI is very good at exactly this kind of work. This toolkit gives you proven prompts you can copy, fill in, and use today. No tech skills needed.

Three steps

1. Open Claude (claude.ai) or the AI assistant you use.
2. Copy a prompt from this guide and replace everything in **[brackets]** with your real details.
3. Read the answer, adjust it if needed ("make it shorter", "more firm"), then use it.

Step 0: Set up a "Dispatch Desk" Project (one time)

In Claude, create a **Project** named "Dispatch Desk" and paste the text below into its instructions. Every chat inside the Project will remember your company, so you never re-explain it.

0. Project instructions

```
You are an assistant to a truck dispatcher at [company name]. We run [number]
trucks, mostly [dry van / reefer / flatbed], in [region/lanes]. Our drivers
communicate by text, so keep driver messages short, clear, and easy to read on a
phone. Use a professional but friendly tone with brokers and customers. Always
flag anything that looks unsafe, illegal, or unrealistic.
```

Planning the Day

1. Morning load assignment

```
Here are today's loads: [paste loads: pickup city/time, delivery city/time, equipment]. Here are my available drivers: [name, current location, hours left on their clock, equipment, home-time needs]. Suggest which driver should take which load to minimize empty miles and respect home time. Flag any conflicts or loads I can't cover.
```

Tip: Use "Driver A, Driver B" instead of real names if you prefer.

2. Can this load be done in time?

```
Driver is in [city] with [X] hours left on the 11-hour driving limit and [X] on the 14-hour clock. Load picks up in [city] at [time] and delivers to [city] by [time]. Is this realistic? Where would they need to take their 10-hour break? Show your reasoning.
```

Tip: This is a second opinion. Your ELD and the driver's logbook always make the final call.

3. Planning the next load (reload)

```
Driver delivers in [city] tomorrow at [time] and needs to be home in [city] by [day]. What lanes and pickup areas should I search on the load board to keep them loaded and moving toward home?
```

Talking to Drivers

4. Rate confirmation to dispatch text

```
Turn this rate confirmation into a short dispatch text for my driver. Include pickup #, appointment times, addresses, commodity, weight, and any special instructions. Put the most important info first. [paste rate con, with the broker's rates and contact info removed]
```

5. Check-call message

```
Write a short, friendly text asking [driver name] for an ETA and status on load [#]. Keep it under 2 sentences.
```

6. Handling a frustrated driver

```
My driver is upset because [situation: long detention, bad load, missed home time]. Help me write a calm, respectful response that acknowledges their frustration, explains what I can do, and keeps them motivated. Don't make promises I can't keep.
```

Tip: Good drivers leave over poor communication. This prompt helps you keep them.

Talking to Brokers & Customers

7. Delay or breakdown notice

```
Write a professional message to the broker letting them know load [#] will be delayed because [reason]. New ETA is [time]. Keep it brief, take responsibility where appropriate, and reassure them it's being handled.
```

8. Detention request

```
My driver arrived at [time] for a [time] appointment and wasn't loaded until [time]. The rate con says detention is $[X] per hour after [X] free hours. Write a firm but polite detention request to the broker and calculate the amount owed.
```

Tip: Double-check the math and attach the driver's in/out times as proof.

9. TONU (truck ordered, not used)

```
The load was canceled after my driver was already dispatched and drove [X] miles. Write a polite but firm TONU request to the broker for $[X].
```

Running the Desk

10. End-of-shift handoff

```
Here are my rough notes from today: [paste notes]. Turn them into a clean handoff summary for the night dispatcher: each truck's status, open problems, and what needs follow-up and when.
```

11. Weekly home-time plan

```
Here are my drivers and their home-time requests for next week: [list]. Help me build a plan that gets everyone home as requested while keeping the trucks loaded. Flag conflicts.
```

12. Turn messy notes into a procedure

```
Here's how we currently handle [process, like breakdowns, new-driver onboarding, or accidents]: [rough notes]. Turn this into a clear, numbered standard operating procedure a new dispatcher could follow.
```

Tip: Great for training new dispatchers faster.

4 Rules for Using AI Safely on the Desk

1. AI doesn't see your ELD, traffic, or weather in real time.

Treat hours-of-service and timing answers as a second opinion. The dispatcher and the logbook make the final call.

2. Remove sensitive information before you paste.

Leave out rates, broker contacts, and drivers' personal information. Use "Driver A" instead of names when you can.

3. Always read it before you send it.

AI writes a strong first draft, but you know your drivers and customers. A 10-second read prevents mistakes.

4. Ask for changes.

If an answer isn't right, just reply: "shorter", "more firm", "friendlier", or "try again with...".

Want this toolkit built for YOUR company?

I'll customize every prompt to your lanes, equipment, and customers, set up your Claude Project, and train your dispatchers to use it. The goal: give your dispatchers hours back every week.

Message me on LinkedIn to book a free 20-minute AI time-saver review.